

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

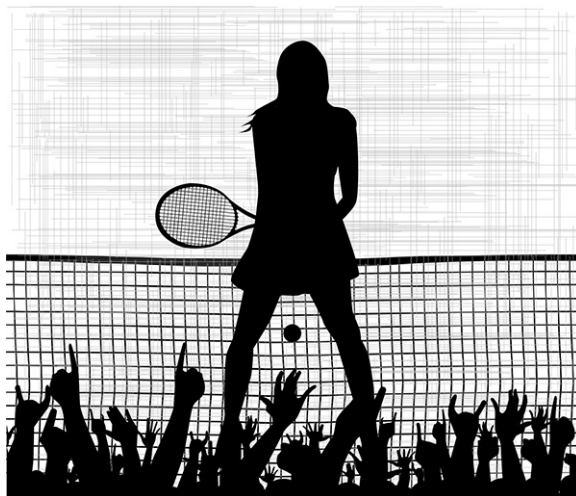
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Let's Start!

The celebrity sportsman ... is it about the game anymore?



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about sports and interests.
- I can talk about feelings and reactions.
- I can talk about habits in the past.

Ask your partner:

- Do you prefer to play sports or watch them on TV? Why?
- How do you feel about the amount of money professional sports players earn?
- Did you use to play sports when you were younger? What did you play?





Let's Explore!

Sally's blog continues. This time she focuses on the sports industry **nowadays***.

* "Nowadays" means at the present time, in contrast with the past.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Becoming a sports player nowadays is more than just being good at what you do. The dream is much bigger and much more complex than that. The situation in modern day sports is often compared to the 1920s - the decade that saw the rise of the celebrity sportsman. Many sports went through a period of transition in the 1920s. Sports used to be largely amateur events. Then, as promoters began to see the potential to capitalize on sports and bring in some money, changes began to happen. Professional football leagues, golf tours, and tennis circuits were organized. Media publicity ensured entertaining events that captivated audiences and guaranteed financial success. This meant raising salaries for the sports stars and allowing for the construction of new stadiums. As people began to watch more sporting events, they would play fewer sports themselves. This trend, which continues to the present day, created a phenomenon of being a "couch potato". Watching a celebrity play baseball became much more captivating than actually playing baseball. Money is such a factor in sports that sports have become commercialized to the point where now, a small number of athletes are exploited to provide entertainment for the masses. Games have become a source of profit and no longer focus on the lessons they used to teach - sportsmanship and moral development.





Let's Practice!

What did sports use to be about?

Instructions: Match the words with each sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|------------------------------|---|
| 1. Sports used to be | so that they could play better themselves. |
| 2. People would play | largely amateur events. a factor in sports. |
| 3. Sports used to be about | fewer sports themselves. |
| 4. People would watch sports | sportsmanship and moral development. |



Let's Practice!

How do people feel about the sports industry?

Instructions: Type in the missing adjective. Choose from entertaining, captivating, terrifying, facinated, or disapointed.

- Media publicity ensured _____ events.
- Watching a celebrity play baseball became more _____ than playing baseball yourself.
- Becoming a sports celebrity is both exciting and _____, since you must be able to handle all the attention.
- Spectators have become _____ with the celebrity of the game, rather than the fame itself.
- Some people feel _____ by the cost of tickets to watch a major league game.





Extension Activity

Let's discuss!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, discuss this question: Do you think people care more about the game or the athlete? Why?
- Describe your opinion using adjectives.
- Keep the discussion going by asking follow-up questions.
- Try to come to a conclusion with your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I discuss the issue of sports.

☐ ☐

My partner and I describe our opinion of sports.

☐ ☐

I keep the discussion going by asking follow-up questions.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **sportsmanship** (noun): fair play, following the rules of a game and being a good loser
e.g. Sports no longer focus on the lessons they used to teach, such as sportsmanship.
- **couch potato** (noun): a person who spends little or no time exercising and a lot of time watching television
e.g. This trend, watching others play sports from the living room chair, created a phenomenon of being a "couch potato".
- **amateur** (noun): a non-professional
Example: Sports used to be largely amateur events.
- **to capitalize** (verb): to make money
e.g. Promoters began to see the potential to capitalize on sports.
- **to exploit** (verb): to use something or someone for personal gain
e.g. A small number of athletes are exploited to provide entertainment for the masses.
- **moral** (adjective): honorable
Example: Games have become a source of profit and no longer focus on the lessons they used to teach - sportsmanship and moral development.





Learning Points

Adjectives About Feelings and Reactions

You talk about feelings and reactions using adjectives. It is important to use the correct kind of adjective - it is common for English language learners to confuse the two kinds of adjectives when talking about feelings and reactions.

1. -ed adjectives

Adjectives that end in **-ed** are used to describe how a person **feels**, like *annoyed*, *fascinated*, *entertained*, *surprised*, *worried* or *tired*.

I am annoyed.

Parents are thrilled.

2. -ing adjectives

Adjectives that end in **-ing** are used to describe things and situations, like *annoying*, *entertaining*, *surprising*, *worrying* or *tiring*. These adjectives describe the **effect** something has on a person.

The study is compelling. (It makes me feel compelled.)

Work is sometimes surprising, too. (It makes me feel tired.)

Examples:

- *Media publicity ensured entertaining events.*
- *Watching a celebrity play baseball became much more captivating than actually playing baseball.*





Learning Points

Used to and Would

Would and **used to** have similar meanings. They are both used to describe something that happened regularly in the past but doesn't happen any longer.

However, there is an important difference between **used to** and **would**.

Would is not used unless you know that the time frame is in the past, while **used to** does not require this.

Read the following example:

We would visit India every summer when we were children.

When we were children refers to a past time frame and therefore makes the meaning of would clear.

We used to visit India every summer.

Here, you do not have to include a past time frame since the meaning of **used to** clear.

Examples:

- *Sports used to be largely amateur events.*
- *As people began to watch more sporting events, they would play fewer sports themselves.*

